Jesujoba Oluwadara Alabi

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Education and Degrees

2022 – 2026 **Ph.D. in Computer Science**, Saarland University, Saarbrücken, Germany.
Thesis title: Advancing African NLP: Adaptation, Analysis, and Evaluation of Large Language Models
Advisor: *Prof. Dr. Dietrich Klakow*
Committee: Prof. Dr.-Ing. André Brinkmann, Prof. Dr. Goran Glavaš, Prof. Dr. Alexander M. Fraser, Dr. Akbar Karimi
Grade: summa cum laude

2018 – 2021 **M.Sc. in Computer Science**, Saarland University, Saarbrücken, Germany.
Thesis title: *Phrase-Enriched Self-Supervised Neural Machine Translation.*
GPA: *1.7 (Best 1.0, Worst 5.0)*

2017 – 2021 **M.Sc. in Computer Science**, University of Ibadan, Ibadan, Nigeria.
Thesis title: *Transfer Learning for Malaria Detection from Thin-Blood Smear Images.*
GPA: *6.7/7*

2011 – 2015 **B.Sc. in Computer Science**, Bowen University, Iwo, Nigeria.
GPA: *4.84/5*

Professional Experience

20/06/22 – Present **Researcher**, Saarland University, Saarbrücken, Germany.
Advisor: *Prof. Dietrich Klakow*

22/01/25 – 28/02/25 **Visiting Ph.D. Student**, National Institute of Informatics, Tokyo, Japan.
Host: *Prof. Junichi Yamagishi*
Topic: *Multlingual text-to-speech*

08/05/24 – 02/08/24 **Research Intern**, National Institute of Informatics, Tokyo, Japan.
Advisor: *Prof. Junichi Yamagishi*
Topic: *Self-supervised learning for under-resourced languages*

01/02/22 – 15/06/22 **Research Engineer**, ALMAnaCH project-team, INRIA, Paris, France.
Advisor: *Dr. Rachel Bawden*
Topic: *Domain adaptation in neural machine translation*

01/08/21 – 28/01/22 **Research Intern**, Max Planck Institute for Informatics, Saarbrücken, Germany.
Advisor: *Dr. Rishiraj Saha Roy*
Topic: *Unified Question Answering over heterogeneous sources*

01/09/20 – 30/07/21 **Research Assistant**, Max Planck Institute for Informatics, Saarbrücken, Germany.

14/11/19 – 31/07/20 **Research Assistant**, German Research Center for Artificial Intelligence, Saarbrücken, Germany.
Advisor: *Dr. Cristina España-Bonet*
Topic: *Self-supervised neural machine translation*

10/01/16 – 30/10/16 **Graduate Assistant**, Afe Babalola University, Ado-Ekiti, Nigeria.
Advisor: *Dr. Oluwaseyi A. Adeyemo*

Research Publications

* indicates joint first authorship

Journal Articles

1. S. Pramanik, **J. Alabi**, R. S. Roy, and G. Weikum, "Uniqorn: Unified question answering over rdf knowledge graphs and natural language text", *Journal of Web Semantics*, vol. 83, 2024.
2. D. I. Adelani, J. Abbott, G. Neubig, D. D'souza, J. Kreutzer, et al., "MasakhaNER: Named entity recognition for African languages", *Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics*, vol. 9, 2021.

Conference Publications

1. A. L. Tonja, S. Anand, E. Villa-Cueva, I. A. Azime, **J. O. Alabi**, et al., "Afri-MCQA: Multimodal cultural question answering for African languages", in *Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, 2026.
2. P. O. Suarez, L. Burchell, C. Arnett, R. Mosquera, S. H. Monsalve, et al., "CommonLID: Re-evaluating state-of-the-art language identification performance on web data", in *Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, 2026.
3. E. T. Bayes*, I. A. Azime*, **J. Alabi***, J. Kgomo, T. Eloundou, et al., "Uhura: A benchmark for evaluating scientific question answering and truthfulness in low-resource african languages", in *Proceedings of the Fifteenth Language Resources and Evaluation Conference (LREC 2026)*, 2026.
4. P. B. Falola, **J. Alabi**, S. O. Akinola, F. T. Ogunajo, E. O. Alabi, et al., "Yoner: A new yorùbá multi-domain named entity recognition dataset", in *Proceedings of the Fifteenth Language Resources and Evaluation Conference (LREC 2026)*, 2026.
5. P. Jajoria, A. Graciotti, G. Casali, **J. Alabi**, R. Delmonte, et al., "Audio-lyrics alignment dataset for italian arias", in *Proceedings of the Fifteenth Language Resources and Evaluation Conference (LREC 2026)*, 2026.
6. K. Uemura, D. Guzmán, Q. P. Nguyen, **J. O. Alabi**, E.-S. A. Lee, et al., "MERLIN: Multi-stage curriculum alignment for multilingual encoder-LLM integration in cross-lingual reasoning", in *Proceedings of the 19th Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, 2026.
7. L. H. Beyene, V. Verma, M. Ma, **J. O. Alabi**, F. D. Schmidt, et al., "Msteb: Massively multilingual evaluation of llms on speech and text tasks", in *IEEE Automatic Speech Recognition and Understanding Workshop, ASRU 2025*, 2025.
8. **J. O. Alabi**, M. A. Hedderich, D. I. Adelani, and D. Klakow, "Charting the landscape of African NLP: Mapping progress and shaping the road ahead", in *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*, 2025.
9. **J. O. Alabi**, I. A. Azime, M. Zhang, C. España-Bonet, R. Bawden, et al., "AFRIDOC-MT: Document-level MT corpus for African languages", in *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*, 2025.
10. L. Kiefer, **J. Alabi**, T. Vakili, H. Dalianis, and D. Klakow, "Instruction-tuning llama for synthetic medical note generation in swedish and english", in *Proceedings of the 15th International Conference on Recent Advances in Natural Language Processing*, 2025.
11. **J. O. Alabi**, X. Liu, D. Klakow, and J. Yamagishi, "Afrihubert: A self-supervised speech representation model for african languages", in *Interspeech*, 2025.
12. H. Yu, **J. O. Alabi**, A. Bukula, J. Y. Zhuang, E.-S. A. Lee, et al., "INJONGO: A multicultural intent detection and slot-filling dataset for 16 African languages", in *Proceedings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics*, 2025.

13. D. I. Adelani, J. Ojo, I. A. Azime, J. Y. Zhuang, **J. O. Alabi**, et al., "IrokoBench: A new benchmark for African languages in the age of large language models", in *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference of the Nations of the Americas Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: Human Language Technologies*, 2025.

14. **J. Alabi**, M. Mosbach, M. Eyal, D. Klakow, and M. Geva, "The hidden space of transformer language adapters", in *Proceedings of the 62nd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics*, 2024.

15. M. Zhang, V. Gautam, M. Wang, **J. Alabi**, X. Shen, et al., "The impact of demonstrations on multilingual in-context learning: A multidimensional analysis", in *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2024*, 2024.

16. D. I. Adelani, H. Liu, X. Shen, N. Vassilyev, **J. O. Alabi**, et al., "SIB-200: A simple, inclusive, and big evaluation dataset for topic classification in 200+ languages and dialects", in *Proceedings of the 18th Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics*, 2024.

17. A. Srivastava, A. Rastogi, A. Rao, A. A. M. Shoeb, A. Abid, et al., "Beyond the imitation game: Quantifying and extrapolating the capabilities of language models", in *Transactions on Machine Learning Research*, 2023.

18. D. I. Adelani, M. Masiak, I. A. Azime, **J. Alabi**, A. L. Tonja, et al., "MasakhaNEWS: News topic classification for African languages", in *Proceedings of the 13th International Joint Conference on Natural Language Processing and the 3rd Conference of the Asia-Pacific Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics*, 2023.

19. A. Krishnan, **J. O. Alabi**, and D. Klakow, "On the n-gram approximation of pre-trained language models", in *Interspeech*, 2023.

20. C. M. B. Dione, D. I. Adelani, P. Nabende, **J. Alabi**, T. Sindane, et al., "MasakhaPOS: Part-of-speech tagging for typologically diverse African languages", in *Proceedings of the 61st Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics*, 2023.

21. **J. O. Alabi***, D. I. Adelani*, M. Mosbach, and D. Klakow, "Adapting pre-trained language models to African languages via multilingual adaptive fine-tuning", in *Proceedings of the 29th International Conference on Computational Linguistics*, 2022.

22. E. Chang, **J. O. Alabi**, D. I. Adelani, and V. Demberg, "Few-shot pidgin text adaptation via contrastive fine-tuning", in *Proceedings of the 29th International Conference on Computational Linguistics*, 2022.

23. D. I. Adelani, **J. O. Alabi**, A. Fan, J. Kreutzer, X. Shen, et al., "A few thousand translations go a long way! leveraging pre-trained models for African news translation", in *Proceedings of the 2022 Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: Human Language Technologies*, 2022.

24. D. I. Adelani*, D. Ruiter*, **J. O. Alabi***, D. Adebonojo, A. Ayeni, et al., "The effect of domain and diacritics in Yoruba–English neural machine translation", in *Proceedings of Machine Translation Summit XVIII: Research Track*, 2021.

25. M. A. Hedderich, D. I. Adelani, D. Zhu, **J. Alabi**, U. Markus, et al., "Transfer learning and distant supervision for multilingual transformer models: A study on African languages", in *Proceedings of the 2020 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2020.

26. **J. O. Alabi***, K. Amponsah-Kaakyire*, D. I. Adelani, and C. España-Bonet, "Massive vs. curated embeddings for low-resourced languages: The case of Yorùbá and Twi", Proceedings of the Twelfth Language Resources and Evaluation Conference, 2020.

Workshop Publications

1. P. Jajoria, Z. Zhong, **J. O. Alabi**, A. Karimi, and D. Klakow, *What matters in a bridge? analysing bridge networks for molecular property prediction*, NeurIPS 2026 Workshop on Agentic Systems for Molecular Sciences, 2026.
2. L. S. Oberkircher, **J. Alabi**, D. Klakow, and J. Trouvain, *Saar-voice: A multi-speaker saarbrücken dialect speech corpus*, Proceedings of the First Workshop on Dialects in NLP — A Resource Perspective, 2026.
3. T. Nakai, R. chikkala, L. Oberkircher, N. Jennings, N. Skachkova, et al., *TReplina: Layer-wise CKA+REPINA alignment improves low-resource machine translation in aya-23 8b*, 1st Workshop on MMLoSo: Multimodal Models for Low-Resource Contexts and Social Impact @ AACL, 2025.
4. **J. O. Alabi**, C. Gong, E. Cooper, Y. Jiang, D. Klakow, et al., *Submission from ZMM-TTS for Blizzard Challenge 2025*, The Blizzard Challenge 2025, 2025.
5. M. Zhang, M. Wang, **J. Alabi**, and D. Klakow, *AAdaM at SemEval-2024 task 1: Augmentation and adaptation for multilingual semantic textual relatedness*, Proceedings of the 18th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation (SemEval-2024), 2024.
6. C. Ilevbare*, **J. Alabi***, D. I. Adelani, F. Bakare, O. Abiola, et al., *EkoHate: Abusive language and hate speech detection for code-switched political discussions on Nigerian Twitter*, Proceedings of the 8th Workshop on Online Abuse and Harms (WOAH 2024), 2024.
7. **J. O. Alabi** and R. Bawden, *Exploring inline lexicon injection for cross-domain transfer in neural machine translation*, Proceedings of the First International Workshop on Knowledge-Enhanced Machine Translation, 2024.
8. A. M. Olawole*, **J. O. Alabi***, A. B. Sakpere, and D. I. Adelani, *YAD: Leveraging t5 for improved automatic diacritization of yorùbá text*, 5th Workshop on African Natural Language Processing, 2024.
9. I. Akinade*, **J. O. Alabi***, D. I. Adelani, C. Odoje, and D. Klakow, *Varepsilon kú mask: Integrating Yorùbá cultural greetings into machine translation*, Proceedings of the First Workshop on Cross-Cultural Considerations in NLP (C3NLP), 2023.
10. I. A. Azime, S. Al-azzawi, A. L. Tonja, I. Shode, **J. Alabi**, et al., *Masakhane-afrisenti at SemEval-2023 task 12: Sentiment analysis using Afro-centric language models and adapters for low-resource African languages*, Proceedings of the 17th International Workshop on Semantic Evaluation (SemEval-2023), 2023.
11. **J. Alabi**, L. Nishimwe, B. Muller, C. Rey, B. Sagot, et al., *Inria-ALMAnaCH at WMT 2022: Does transcription help cross-script machine translation?*, Proceedings of the Seventh Conference on Machine Translation (WMT), 2022.
12. I. Abdulmumin*, M. Beukman*, **J. Alabi***, C. C. Emezue, E. Chimoto, et al., *Separating grains from the chaff: Using data filtering to improve multilingual translation for low-resourced African languages*, Proceedings of the Seventh Conference on Machine Translation (WMT), 2022.
13. S. Tchistiakova, **J. Alabi**, K. Dutta Chowdhury, S. Dutta, and D. Ruiter, *EdinSaar@WMT21: North-Germanic low-resource multilingual NMT*, Proceedings of the Sixth Conference on Machine Translation, 2021.
14. S. Dutta*, **J. Alabi***, S. Bandyopadhyay, D. Ruiter, and J. van Genabith, *UdS-DFKI@WMT20: Unsupervised MT and very low resource supervised MT for German-Upper Sorbian*, Proceedings of the Fifth Conference on Machine Translation, Online, 2020.

Preprints

1. A. L. Tonja, T. D. Belay, **J. O. Alabi**, I. A. Azime, B. Rosman, et al., "Measuring research progress and linguistic inclusion in low-resource languages", 2026.
2. I. A. Azime*, **J. O. Alabi***, I. Maab, A. Cai, T. D. Belay, et al., "Afriguard: Safety and robust refusal for african languages", 2026.

3. I. A. Azime*, **J. O. Alabi***, T. R. Gwadabe, and D. I. Adelani, "African languages ai safety readiness report", 2026.
4. P. Chen, K. D. Chowdhury, X. Xu, D. Tan, D. Osmelak, et al., "Cultivar: A contrastive and locale-oriented translation benchmark for investigating contamination and localisation robustness", 2026.
5. I. A. Azime, **J. O. Alabi**, C. Zhang, I. Maab, A. L. Tonja, et al., "Afrifact: Cultural information retrieval, evidence extraction and fact checking for african languages", (to appear EMNLP 2026), 2026.
6. **J. O. Alabi**, J. Herreilers, B. M. Abdullah, and D. Klakow, *From monolingual to multilingual: Evaluating mamba for asr in south african languages*, 2026.
7. D. Guzmán, L. H. Beyene, **J. O. Alabi**, Y. Jeon, D. Klakow, et al., "Openbibletts: Large-scale speech resources and tts models for low-resource languages", 2026.
8. B. M. Abdullah, I. A. Azime, A. L. Tonja, **J. O. Alabi**, A. M. Alemu, et al., "Ethio-asr: Joint multilingual speech recognition and language identification for ethiopian languages", 2026.
9. A. Aremu, **J. O. Alabi**, D. Abolade, N. F. Aguobi, S. H. Muhammad, et al., "Naijarc: A multi-choice reading comprehension dataset for nigerian languages", 2024.

Miscellaneous Experience

Research Grants

03/25 – Present — AfriFact & AfriGuard: Dataset for Fact-Checking and Robust Refusal.
(Co-PI with Israel Abebe Azime, **USD $113,332.50** funded by Lacuna Fund)

05/23 – 08/24 — NiLE: Using language technologies to spread educational content in Nigerian languages.
(Co-PI with Kola Tubosun, **CAD $45, 000** funded by Africa AI4D-EduAI Hub)

10/23 – 08/24 — MASAKHANE DAMT: Domain adaptation datasets for African languages.
(PI, **USD $66, 875** Masakhane project funded by Lacuna Fund 2022)

Awards and Scholarships

2026 — **Kempner Institute Research Fellowship**, Harvard University
Awarded; fellowship not yet taken up due to U.S. visa circumstances

Social Impact Paper Award, ACL 2026, San Diego

SAC Highlight Award, ACL 2026, San Diego

2025 — **Outstanding Paper Award**, NAACL 2025, New Mexico

2024 — **Best System Description Paper Award**, SemEval 2024, NAACL 2024, Mexico

2023 — **Area Chair Award(Resources and Evaluation)**, AACL 2023, Indonesia

2022 — **Best Paper Award (Grand Challenge KISTI category)**, COLING 2022, South Korea

2021 — **1st prize**, AI4D Takwimu Lab - Machine Translation Challenge

2020 — **STIBET III DAAD Graduation Grant**, Saarland Scholarship for International Students

2019 — **Black in AI travel grant**, 2019 Neurips at Vancouver

Summer School and Workshop

03/25 — **HumanCLAIM Workshop**, University of Göttingen, Germany

10/24 — **GCND doctoral school/hackathon**, Ghent University, Belgium

09/24 — **Athens NLP Summer School**, NCSR Demokritos Campus, Greece

07/20 — **Lisbon Machine Learning School** , Online

Miscellaneous Experience (continued)

Peer Review

- 2026 — Reviewer - ACL ARR (May)
- Emergency reviewer - ACL ARR (March)
- Area chair - LREC 2026
- 2025 — Emergency area chair - ACL ARR (May, October)
- Reviewer - COLING, HRI '25, ACL ARR (May, July), AfricaNLP Workshop
- 2024 — Reviewer - LREC-COLING, AfricaNLP Workshop
- 2023 — Reviewer - AfriCHI, AfricaNLP Workshop, EMNLP
- 2022 — Reviewer - WMT

Teaching Experience and Academic Service

Teaching Experience

- 2023 — Co-taught Seminar on Machine Learning for Natural Language Processing and Beyond (with Prof. Dr. Dietrich Klakow)

Workshop Organization

- 2027 — **Shared Task Co-organizer**, 7th Multilingual Representation Learning Workshop, co-located with TBD
- 2026 — **Publication Chair & Shared Task Co-organizer**, 6th Multilingual Representation Learning Workshop, co-located with EMNLP, Budapest

Guest, Invited and Keynote Lectures

- 12/07/2026 — **Guest Lecture**, ResearchRound, Nigeria (Shaping AI from African Contexts Fellowship) [Online]
  Title: Overview of Natural Language Processing
- 08/04/2026 — **Invited Talk**, Department of Linguistics (Faculty of Arts), University of Ibadan, Nigeria
  Title: Building NLP for African Languages: Challenges and Opportunities
- 13/09/2025 — **Keynote Talk**, Workshop on Advancing NLP for Low-Resource Languages at RANLP [Varna, Bulgaria]
  Title: Bridging the Gap: Low-Resource NLP for African Languages
- 03/09/2025 — **Guest Lecture**, Machine Translation, University of Ibadan, Nigeria [Online]
  Title: Neural Machine Translation
- 26/08/2025 — **Invited Talk**, Erasmus LCT Summer School, DFKI, Saarbrücken, Germany
  Title: Adaptation at Scale: Making Multilingual Models Work for Underrepresented Languages
- 31/07/2025 — **Keynote Talk**, AfricaNLP Workshop at ACL [Vienna, Austria]
  Title: Mapping Progress in African NLP
- 17/10/2024 — **Guest Lecture**, Collaborative Research, Houghton University, USA [Online]
  Title: NLP for African Languages
- 04/09/2020 — **Invited Talk**, Data Science for Social Impact Research Group, University of Pretoria, South Africa [Online]
  Title: Massive vs. Curated Embeddings for Low-Resourced Languages: the Case of Yorùbá and Twi
- 03/07/2020 — **Invited Talk**, AI4D Africa Webinar Series [Online]
  Title: Yoruba and beyond: NLP from an African perspective

Teaching Experience and Academic Service (continued)

Research Seminar

21/05/2026 — Transducens research group, Universitat d'Alacant, Spain
Title: African NLP Across Scales: Models, Culture, and Documents

18/05/2026 — HiTZ zentroa, San Sebastián, Spain
Title: Scaling and Evaluating Large Language Models for African Languages

Thesis Supervision

2025 — **Katharina Trinley**, A Mechanistic Understanding of Pronoun Fidelity in LLMs. [Masters]

Lena Sophie Oberkircher, Saar-Voice: A Multi-Speaker Saarbrücken Dialect Speech Corpus. [Masters]

2024 — **Lotta Elisa Kiefer**, Instruction-Tuning LLaMA for Synthetic Medical Note Generation: Bridging Data Privacy and Utility in Downstream Tasks. [Masters]

Sambit Bhaumik, Leveraging Multilingual FAQ Resources for Enhanced Cross-Lingual Information Retrieval. [Masters]

2023 — **Jeremy Mika Büdinger**, Investigating Adapter-based Fine-Tuning for Luxembourgish. [Bachelors]

References

Available on Request